PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #74 · SUBSTANCE ABUSE

“One more time won’t matter. I’ll quit tomorrow.”

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Where it often comes from

“One more time won’t matter. I’ll quit tomorrow” is a kind sentence people tell themselves so today does not have to change. Tomorrow stays clean because it never arrives. This is not proof that you are a liar or a hopeless case. It is a very common way to lower the fear of stopping. The mercy in it, if you can hear it, is that you already know you want a different day. The lie is that today is too small to matter and that a promise about tomorrow is the same thing as a plan. A plan includes a person who can help, and a doctor if stopping could make you sick. If you want help, call the SAMHSA National Helpline at 1-800-662-4357. Do not try to stop or withdraw on your own if that could make you sick. A doctor can help you do it safely, and a counselor can walk with you. Needing that help is not a failure.

What Scripture teaches

Proverbs says not to boast about tomorrow, because you do not know what a day may bring. That is not a threat. It is a kindness that brings you back to the day you are actually in. You can approach God today for mercy and help. Your help comes from the Lord. Today has enough trouble of its own, which also means today is the day you are allowed to act, not only to promise. Jesus sets people free. None of this says “shame yourself for every delay.” It says a postponed promise is not the same as help received.

> *“Do not boast about tomorrow, for you do not know what a day may bring”* (Proverbs 27:1).

Also see

> “Let us then approach the throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need” (Hebrews 4:16).

> “I lift up my eyes to the hills. From where does my help come? My help comes from the LORD, the Maker of heaven and earth” (Psalm 121:1–2).

> “Therefore do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself. Today has enough trouble of its own” (Matthew 6:34).

> “So if the Son sets you free, you will be free indeed” (John 8:36).

Common self-statements

- This time does not count.
- I will be different tomorrow.
- I have said it before, so saying it again is pointless.
- Today is already ruined, so I might as well.
- If I ask for help today, I have admitted I cannot quit on my own schedule.
- God is keeping score of every delay.

Common logical errors

- Minimization: Calling another time “nothing” so you do not have to feel it.
- Fortune telling: Treating a tomorrow you cannot see as a reliable plan.
- All-or-nothing thinking: If today is not a perfect quit, today is worthless.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling done with the day and deciding the day is allowed to be given up.

Challenging questions

- How many tomorrows have I already spent?
- What would a plan include that a promise does not?
- What is one step that is smaller than quitting forever?
- Who needs to know, so this is not only a private bargain?
- What would be unsafe about deciding to stop tonight with no medical help?
- What help is available today, not next month?

Truth summary

> One more time does matter, and tomorrow is not a plan. I can take one honest step today, with help.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

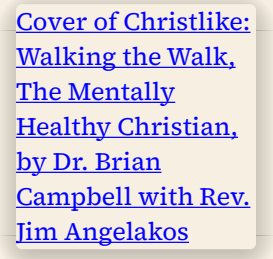
- Thinking, Healthy
- Faith
- Help
- Peace
- Joy

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Thinking, Healthy
- Prayer
- Truth

What does a mentally healthy Christian look like?



From *Christlike: Walking the Walk* by Dr. Brian Campbell. A portrait, verse by verse, of how a mentally healthy Christian thinks, feels, and lives.

Read excerpts from “The Mentally Healthy Christian” (with every Scripture written out)

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Listen: Overcoming Depression

Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Even If — MercyMe
You can take a true step today even if you do not feel ready for forever.

Do It Again — Steven Curtis Chapman
God's mercy meets you again. Tomorrow is not the only day He helps.

Thrive — Casting Crowns
A real life is allowed to start before you feel impressive.

Because He Lives — Bill and Gloria Gaither
Because He lives, today is a day you can ask for help.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, what is one step I could take today?"

My Plan for Replacing "One more time won't matter. I'll quit tomorrow."

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"One more time won't matter. I'll quit tomorrow." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ How many tomorrows have I already spent?
- ☐ What would a plan include that a promise does not?
- ☐ What is one step that is smaller than quitting forever?
- ☐ Who needs to know, so this is not only a private bargain?
- ☐ What would be unsafe about deciding to stop tonight with no medical help?
- ☐ What help is available today, not next month?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ One more time does matter, and tomorrow is not a plan. I can take one honest step today, with help.
- ☐ A promise about tomorrow is not the same as help today.
- ☐ Today is small enough to be a real step.
- ☐ I am not a failure because I have said "tomorrow" before.
- ☐ I can tell someone the promise instead of keeping it in my head.
- ☐ A doctor can help me make stopping safe.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Proverbs 27:1**
  "Do not boast about tomorrow, for you do not know what a day may bring."
- ☐ **Hebrews 4:16**
  "Let us then approach the throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need."
- ☐ **Psalm 121:1–2**
  "I lift up my eyes to the hills. From where does my help come? My help comes from the LORD, the Maker of heaven and earth."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When you moved it to tomorrow: Each day, write down one moment when one more time felt like it would not matter. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Proverbs 27:1 becomes: "James can write: "I do not know tomorrow. I can ask for help today.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Thinking, Healthy" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio or the Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. For help with substance use, call 1-800-662-4357, and talk with a doctor before you stop if withdrawal could make you sick.

- [ ] Trade the promise for a call. Instead of "tomorrow," call 1-800-662-4357 or tell your counselor what you were about to delay.
- [ ] Do not make "tonight I stop cold" the step if withdrawal could make you sick. Ask a doctor what a safe step is.
- [ ] Write today's step on paper before the day is over: one person to tell, or one appointment to request.
- [ ] Pray Proverbs 27:1 as a return to today, not as a speech against yourself.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "One more time won't matter. I'll quit tomorrow.": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A step I did not postpone
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~One more time won't matter. I'll quit tomorrow~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I keep moving this to tomorrow. Bring me back to today. Give me one honest step and a safe person to take it with. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.